

EMMA GETZ

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EDUCATION

Appalachian State University, Boone, NC

December 2025

Bachelor of Science in Public Health, Minor in Statistics

GPA: 3.73

Relevant Coursework: Public Health Evaluation, Biostatistics, Epidemiology, Public Health Interventions, Health Policy, Ethics, and Law, Statistical Methods, Reasoning with Statistics, Data Management and Visualization, Rural Health, Community Health, Health Communication

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Sheps Center for Health Services Research (NC-BELL)

Chapel Hill, NC,

June 2026 - August 2026

- Conducted literature reviews on crisis services, behavioral health, and psychiatric hospitalizations to inform study design and support project deliverables for a state-funded initiative.
- Compiled and organized data on NC crisis service providers by integrating multiple secondary data sources (NPI records, geographic datasets), strengthening program data-tracking systems.
- Developed data collection guides and documentation protocols to support reproducibility; authored summary reports for presentation of findings to state-level stakeholders.

Rural Public Health AmeriCorps

Boone, North Carolina,

Lead Fellow

October 2025 - May 2026

- Led program coordination for a federally funded rural public health fellowship, managing timelines and logistics across multiple concurrent professional development initiatives.
- Organized professional development programming for AmeriCorps fellows, including career panels, resume workshops, and skill-building training, to strengthen fellows' job readiness and expand public health workforce capacity in rural communities.
- Coordinated conference participation for fellows, managing logistics, scheduling, and presentation deliverables.
- Designed and executed a recruitment and outreach strategy, including promotional materials and stakeholder engagement events, to expand program visibility across rural communities.

Data & Evaluation Team Lead

November 2024 - August 2025

- Directed a data and evaluation team overseeing outcomes evaluation for a grant-funded rural mental health intervention (RAPID-PFA), managing data collection, quality assurance, and statistical analysis of 200+ pre/post surveys.
- Conducted a literature review and wrote a manuscript based on RAPID-PFA implementation.
- Authored an abstract and presented evaluation findings at the NC Public Health Data Summit.
- Synthesized three years of program and participant data into a comprehensive performance report to support continuous quality improvement and program planning.

Departmental Honors Thesis, Appalachian State University

Boone, North Carolina,

November 2024 - December 2025

- Conceptualized and conducted an independent research project on tick-borne illness prevention in long-distance Appalachian Trail hikers, including a comprehensive literature review and original survey instrument, under Dr. Richard Christiana, Chair of the Department of Public Health.
- Established and managed a partnership with the Appalachian Trail Conservancy, coordinating with an external stakeholder organization to incorporate input into survey design and ensure community relevance.
- Coordinated and executed community-engaged data collection both in-person and online, achieving a target of 250 survey responses.
- Analyzed data in SPSS using linear regression to identify key relationships in data.
- Authored a formal manuscript for submission to a peer-reviewed academic journal.

Research Intern, MaineHealth Institute for Research

Portland, Maine,

June 2025 - August 2025

- Analyzed data from 1,544 youth across specialized psychiatric units to identify key features of profound autism and deepen understanding of this under-researched group.
- Conducted a literature review, interpreted findings, and prepared a manuscript based on results for submission to a peer-reviewed academic journal. Assisted in grant proposal development.
- Presented research outcomes through a 3-Minute Thesis competition and poster session, engaging 100+ colleagues and researchers.

AppHealthCare - Boone, NC

Youth Risk Behavior Survey Data Analyst

June 2025 - August 2025

- Analyzed adolescent health and behavior survey data from local middle and high schools to identify trends relevant to youth well-being and highlight areas needing improvement.
- Produced school-specific reports with data visualizations and dashboards highlighting youth health trends, translating survey findings into actionable summaries for school stakeholders.
- Collaborated with an interdisciplinary team to create more efficient project workflows.

Research Assistant, Research Institute for Environment, Energy and Economics

Boone, North Carolina,

November 2023 - May 2024

- Analyzed 100+ crisis text conversations using thematic analysis, identifying patterns in eco-anxiety and climate worry and assessing their impacts on mental health.
- Co-authored a peer-reviewed publication on the mental health effects of the climate crisis, collaborating with an interdisciplinary team on drafting and manuscript preparation.

HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Public Health Departmental Honors, Appalachian State University (December 2025)
- The Paul Gray Research Scholarship, MaineHealth Institute for Research (June 2025)
- Chancellor's List & Dean's List, Appalachian State University (2021-2025)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed

Getz, E., Christiana, R. W., & Seagle, S. W. (2026). Tick-borne disease prevention in long-distance Appalachian Trail hikers: A health belief model approach. *Wilderness & Environmental Medicine*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10806032261459977>

Runkle, J. D., Herbst, K., Ryan, S., Sewell, K., Mallare, A., Berry, I., **Getz, E.**, McKee, A., Thompson, M. P., & Sugg, M. M. (2025). Eco-anxiety, climate concern, and fatalistic outlooks: Insights from U.S. crisis text conversations on climate distress. *The Journal of Climate Change and Health*, 22(1), 100419. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.joclim.2025.100419>

Non-Peer-Reviewed

Getz, E. (2025, July 10). *Tick Smart: 5 Tips for Hikers to Prevent Tick-Borne Illness*. Appalachian Trail Conservancy. <https://appalachiantrail.org/official-blog/tick-smart-trail-tips/>

PRESENTATIONS

Getz, E. “Trail-Proven Tick Prevention: Preventing Tick-Borne Illness on the Appalachian Trail.” Oral Presentation, Appalachian Trail Days Festival, Appalachian Trail Conservancy Damascus Trail Center, Damascus, VA, May 2026.

Getz, E. “Characterizing Profound Autism in an Enriched Sample: Insights from the Autism Inpatient Collection.” Oral and Poster Presentations, Summer Undergraduate Research Program Final Presentations, MaineHealth Institute for Research, Portland, ME, August 2025.

Getz, E., Hunt, K., Overton S., Bennett, T., Tyson, J.S. “Evaluation of the RAPID Psychological First Aid (PFA) Training Program in Rural Appalachian Western NC: 2022-2024.” Oral Presentation, North Carolina Public Health Data Summit, Asheville, NC, May 2025.

Getz, E. “Ticks on the Trail: Practical Prevention for Hikers.” Oral Presentation, Appalachian Trail Days Festival, Appalachian Trail Conservancy Damascus Trail Center, Damascus, VA, May 2025.

Getz, E. & Christiana, R. “Tick-Borne Disease Prevention in Long-Distance Appalachian Trail Hikers: A Health Belief Model Approach.” Poster Presentation, Celebration of Student Research and Creative Endeavors, Appalachian State University, Boone, NC, April 2025.

CERTIFICATIONS

CITI Good Clinical Practice: Collaborative Institute Training Initiative | April 2025

Psychological First Aid: Appalachian State Public Health AmeriCorps | January 2025

CITI Social/Behavioral Research: Collaborative Institute Training Initiative | September 2024

SKILLS

Technical: R, SPSS, Qualtrics, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Calendar)

Professional: Program Evaluation, Outcomes Evaluation & Reporting, Stakeholder Engagement & Coordination, Data Management and Analysis, Cross-Institutional Collaboration, Research Methods, Survey Design, Literature Reviews, Scientific Writing, Leadership